

in extracting tracks from an audio CD. The Panther comes with an ample onboard buffer of 2 MB. The writer managed to reach an average read speed of 30x in the Nero CD Speed test. It comes bundled with a host of software such as HotBurn (CD Writing suite), Iomega QuickSync (protects files from deletion, viruses etc),

Price: Rs 18,000
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MGI PhotoSuite, Adobe ActiveShare and Musicmatch Jukebox. It also bundles one blank CD-R (but no CD-RW) and a detailed user manual.

SPECIFICATIONS:
 16/10/40x speed, USB 2.0 interface backward compatible, 2 MB buffer

IOMEGA Panther		B
Performance	★ ★ ★	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★	
Features	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ 1/2	

Philips 107B3 Flat Monitor with LightFrame II

Who's the bright one?



The 107B3 is the new flat screen monitor from Philips, featuring LightFrame II technology. This feature brightens a select part on the screen. LightFrame II consists of an integrated circuit hard wired in the monitor, which in conjunction with software dramatically increases the brightness of the selected region. This works beautifully while watching movies, images or playing games, as it makes the display very crisp and clear. However, if the area is left bright and you start using applications that involve a lot of text, then the ghosting

Price: Rs 16,000
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effect becomes prominent and puts a lot of strain on the eyes. The monitor was put through the Display Mate test wherein it performed satisfactorily. In the screen regulation test, the screen size increased by at least 1 mm, which is tolerable. The monitor even showed a prominent moiré pattern in the horizontal and diagonal resolution test. During normal functioning (without Lightframe II), the monitor didn't show any streaking or ghosting effects. This monitor is capable of an amazing maximum resolution of 1600x1200 at 75 Hz. Very few 17-inch monitors can claim to run at such a high resolution at any decent refresh rate.

SPECIFICATIONS:
 Maximum resolution of 1600x1200 at 75 Hz resolution, 16 inch viewable area, 240 MHz video bandwidth, 96 KHz horizontal scan rate

Philips 107B3		B+
Performance	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Features	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ 1/2	

Logitech Clicksmart510

Picture hoarder

The Logitech ClickSmart510 camera offers a 1.3 mega pixel still image resolution (software rendered) and a built-in microphone that can be used for video conferencing on the Net. The camera has a USB interface for quick transfer of photos to the PC. The camera is equipped with an 8 MB SmartMedia card, which stores over 120 images at a decent resolution of 640x480. It has two focus settings, Close up and Distance mode. While the quality was pretty neat for a camera of its type, indoor photographs were a little dark despite there being a fair amount of ambient light. The camera comes bundled with a host of software such as the MGI PhotoSuite SE, MGI VideoWave SE, Digital Radar motion detection software, and Intelligent QuickSync. It has good ergonomics and the

Price: Rs 15,000
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buttons are smartly placed. If you are going to use it for fun and as a Web cam, then its quality and bundled software will definitely impress you. However, a price of Rs 15,000 makes it very expensive for the resolution it offers.

SPECIFICATIONS:
 640x480 pixel resolution, 8 MB SmartMedia card, USB interface, adjustable swivel base included, 4 AAA batteries, 640x480 pixel video capture

Logitech Clicksmart		B+
Performance	★ ★ ★	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Features	★ ★ ★	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ 1/2	

Creative PC-CAM 300

You deserve a better shot

Creative PC-CAM 300 comes with 8 MB built-in memory, which can store up to 120 photographs at a resolution of 640x480. The camera can take the snaps at a resolution of 1024x768 and has a built-in flash with a setting for red-eye reduction. It comes bundled with a host of software to build Web sites, edit photographs, capture images, and so on. The software, however, will take some getting used to.



The installation process was too long and we had to restart the system for it to detect the camera. The camera also has a built-in microphone for capturing audio while recording a movie. The movie can be captured at resolutions ranging from 160x120 to 640x480 pixels. The images were very dark even in a well-lit room and distant photographs were a bit washed out and hazy, as